

XMage: MTG Mechanics Not Implemented or Not Planned

Succinct research summary based on XMage upstream wiki/issues plus local source spot-checks.

Key Takeaway

The strongest confirmed gaps are ante, text-changing effects, subgames, contraptions, draft-matters, Host/Augment, art/artist/expansion-symbol matters, dexterity effects, and outside-the-game/person effects. Perpetually is still open upstream. Paradigm and Mutate are branch-sensitive and should be verified against the selected checkout before being treated as missing.

Confirmed Not Planned / Very Unlikely

Mechanic	Status	Why	Card Examples
Ante	Not planned	Card ownership outside the digital game has no clear XMage model.	Contract From Below; Darkpact; Jeweled Bird; Bronze Tablet; Timmerian Fiends; Amulet of Quoz
Text-changing effects	Not planned	Would require mutable rules text/color/type references across thousands of implementations.	Magical Hack; Sleight of Mind; Mind Bend; Whim of Volrath; Crystal Spray; Alter Reality; Artificial Evolution; Exchange of Words; New Blood
Subgames	Very unlikely	Nested game state is a major engine problem.	Shahrazad; Enter the Dungeon; The Countdown Is at One
Contraptions / Assemble	Very unlikely	Needs Contraption deck, sprockets, crank state, and extra-deck handling.	Steamflogger Boss; Steamflogger of the Month; Steamflogger Temp; Unstable Contraptions
Draft-matters	Very unlikely	Cards modify the draft process rather than the game after deck construction.	Cogwork Librarian; Lore Seeker; Agent of Acquisitions; Canal Dredger; Cogwork Spy
Host / Augment	Unstable tracking open	Requires special half-card composition and combined cards.	Host: Angelic Rocket, Big Boa Constrictor, Dirty Rat. Augment: Half-Kitten, Half-, Bat-, Ninja-
Art / artist / expansion-symbol matters	Very unlikely	Depends on visual/card-art metadata outside normal engine rules.	Aesthetic Consultation; Artful Looter; Circle of Protection: Art; Drawn Together; Abstract Iguanart; Symbol Status
Dexterity effects	Impossible	Physical flipping/aiming cannot be simulated fairly.	Chaos Orb; Falling Star
People / outside-the-game effects	Impossible	Requires real people, real objects, speech, photos, or social behavior outside the simulator.	Flavor Judge; Art Appreciation; Animate Object; Photo Op; Better Than One; Gobsnacked

Open / Branch-Dependent

Mechanic	Current Read	Examples
Perpetually	Open upstream PR #13016; not found in local source spot-check.	Davriel, Soul Broker; Fearsome Whelp; Racketeer Boss; Tenacious Pup
Paradigm	Open draft PR #14684, but present in this local checkout.	Decorum Dissertation; Germination Practicum; Echocasting Symposium; Improvisation Capstone; Restoration Seminar
Mutate	Conflicting evidence: wiki/issue say difficult/in progress; local checkout has MutateAbility and many mutate cards.	Brokkos, Apex of Forever; Dirge Bat; Gemrazer; Sea-Dasher Octopus; Vadrok, Apex of Thunder

Miscellaneous Single-Card Engine Gaps

Some difficult cards are not broad mechanics but still deserve importer warnings: Spy Kit; Who // What // When // Where // Why; Ertai's Meddling; No Quarter; Magnetic Web.

Importer Recommendation

For the Card Importer Workbench, flag the confirmed categories above as "human engine review required" or "not planned/upstream unsupported". Treat Perpetually, Paradigm, and Mutate as checkout-sensitive: scan the selected checkout first and avoid hard-coding them as missing.

Primary Sources

- XMage wiki: List of cards that will not be implemented on Xmage
- magefree/mage issue #11319: Ante Cards - not planned
- magefree/mage issue #2082: Implement text-changing effects - not planned
- magefree/mage issue #4233: UST - Unstable card implementation tracking
- magefree/mage issue #6390: IKO / Mutate implementation tracking
- magefree/mage PR #13016: Implement perpetually mechanic
- magefree/mage PR #14684: WIP - Implement Paradigm mechanic
- Local source spot-checks in F:\xmage for MutateAbility, ParadigmAbility, text-changing cards, and missing set entries.